

Dr Jonathon Alexis Coates

Email: Jonathon.a.coates@gmail.com

Phone: 07450322210

Web: <http://jacoates.co.uk/>

I lead global open-science and research-culture programmes and have done so for ten years across nonprofits, universities, and international collaborations. At ASAPbio I set the 2025–27 strategy which secured \$300,000 in funding; I have trained over 300 researchers, published two corresponding-author papers on preprint quality, and served as an expert source for the BBC and The Economist.

Relevant experience

Senior Training Officer (2026 - Present)

UK Biobank

- Established a new researcher training team within the organisation, including securing £26,000 for a dedicated training platform and designing a 3 year strategy
- Line-managed the team's first training officer; brokered the first joint training workflow between training and community, replacing ad hoc requests with a shared process

Associate Director (2023 - 2025)

ASAPBio

- Developed and implemented strategic initiatives, including devising the 2025-27 direction of ASAPbio & all community initiatives, resulting in >\$300,000 secured in funding
- Served as interim Executive Director for 4 months, leading to a record breaking year for ASAPbio with a 330% increase in engagement, 51% increase in newsletter subscriptions and a 64% increase in fellows applications
- Consolidated ASAPbio's scattered community programmes into a single core offering, which became the platform for the 2025–27 strategy
- Recruited, trained and mentored over 100 international ASAPbio Fellows and other researchers in open science practices to highly positive feedback
- Designed multi-format communication materials and strategy (video, social media, writing), including ASAPbio's most-viewed and engaged with YouTube content
- Provided leadership to the wider open science and metascience communities, building partnerships and collaborating with researchers, funders, institutions and publishers, resulting in a significant expansion across Africa

Executive Director (2020 - Present)

Rippling Ideas

- Founded and lead an independent [initiative](#) focused on open science, research culture, trust in research and science communication. Incorporated in September 2025.
- Designed and delivered international training, advocacy, and engagement programmes to 200+ people
- Delivered 40+ invited talks to a variety of stakeholders, including chairing panel sessions
- Authored 18+ opinion pieces ([The Scientist](#), [The Conversation](#)) and served as an expert source for the [BBC](#), [The Economist](#), [Popular Science](#), [German](#) and [Austrian](#) National radio
- Led an international metascience collaboration on preprint quality, publishing two senior-author papers (PLOS Biology [2021](#), [2022](#)) that drew [media coverage](#) across 40 outlets including Nature and The Economist
- Built and developed a [podcast](#) promoting open science and underrepresented voices; reaching the top 20 charts across 11 countries
- Led a remote editorial team of five across production, outreach, and strategy for five years

- Created and grew a 450+ member [community](#) for UK/EU postdocs, recognised by the UK's national research funder as a valuable community building initiative
- Built international relationships with partners in open science, including the Africa Reproducibility Network

BHF Postdoctoral Research Scientist (2020 - 2023) Queen Mary, University of London

- Led a three-year British Heart Foundation–funded research project end to end, from experimental design through analysis to publication
- Project management and leadership of a research project which involved; designing and performing experiments, data analysis, data presentation and paper writing
- Presented at invited talks across the UK to disseminate the outcomes of research to scientific audiences and on panels discussing the importance of open science
- Supervised 7 early career researchers, ensuring successful dissertations and training in academic skills

Postdoctoral Research Scientist (2019 - 2020) Babraham Institute, University of Cambridge

- Established and developed techniques new to the lab and wrote all lab-associated SOPs
- Appointed Postdoctoral Associate at Hughes Hall College, serving on the post-doc committee

PhD researcher (2015 - 2019) University of Sheffield

- [Uncovered](#) the existence of macrophage subtypes in *Drosophila* and demonstrated functional differences between the populations
- Collaborated with other group members on additional projects and [publications](#)
- Chaired the department PhD student committee, which included organising a seminar series, 2-day scientific retreat (for ~100 people) and team management
- Project and team lead for the 2016-17 Sheffield iGEM entry; Co-developed the project and designed the experimental plan with a £50,000 budget. Independently led the project for its duration, training and managing a team of 17 (10 undergraduates, 5 PhD students and 2 postdocs). Awarded a gold medal and nominated for best diagnostic project
- Received the first Ian Peake award for positive contributions to the department reputation

Other Communication & Public Engagement

Public engagement: I'm a Scientist (2022), Researchers night (2016-2018), Our Immune Army (2017), Festival of Life (2016-2017), International radio appearances, 6 podcast appearances, various contributions to news pieces (incl. [Nature](#), [The Economist](#), [Popular Science](#)), Video [primer](#) on preprints for UKRN (2022)

Teaching: Open Science Training (2023-), Research student supervision (2018, 2021-2023), [Preprints in Life Sciences Syllabus](#) (2021), Lab demonstrating (2018), A-level Biology (2012, 2014-2015)

Scientific Advisory Boards: EMBL-EBI Europe PMC (2022-2026), eRxiv (2024-2025), AREN (2024-)

Board of directors: eRxiv (2026-)

Education

Ph.D.	2015-2019	Immunology & Molecular biology , University of Sheffield
MRes	2014-2015	Immunobiology (Distinction) , Newcastle University
B.Sc.	2010-2013	Biomedical Science (1st) , University of Northumbria. Awarded Dean's list for outstanding academic achievement

